

Immersive functions

Audio in games adds realism or creates illusion to immerse the player into the game. This is known as “Suspension of Disbelief”. Earlier in films, sounds were used of covering distracting noises of the projector in the silent era of the



Screen shot of Limbo

film. Similarly, this can be seen in Arcade games also. They have more sound effects and percussion to make the player concentrate on the game and cover external distracting sounds from other sources. Now-a-days, in home consoles, game sounds which help to drown out or mask external sound in order to focus on the task at hand.

Kinetic functions

In some games, game sounds are made in such a way that players respond to the sounds physically. Best example is, Dance Dance Revolution. Some games are expected the player to directly interact and respond with sound. The sound in the case of kinetic games serves as a main motivating factor, arousing the player physically, and is also the part of the game on which the player must focus attention and with which the player interacts.

Aesthetic functions

In the days of the arcades, when there were dozens of arcade machines on a floor, sound was a critical factor in helping to entice a player to a particular game. Hence, sound technology for the arcades grew far more quickly than sound for home consoles, as creators knew the value of having an attractive sound in their game. While the popularity of arcades has faded, sound is still used to create beauty or atmosphere, and can make the difference between a game being soothing or violent. As evidence, sound and music are typically given ratings in reviews and play an important role.

The aesthetics can also give us clues as to what genre of game we can expect. The introductory music to a game that is slow and soft, for instance, usually indicates the game has a slow pace and will take considerable time. Faster music is usually indicative of shorter and more action-orientated games. Certain genres of music adapt well to certain types of games, especially since different types of games have different requirements for inter-